

PREMIUM

Pre-Departure Checklist

From visa/eVisa confirmed to enrolling at your UK institution

2-4 weeks before departure

- Confirm your visa status - check whether you have a digital eVisa (create/check your UKVI account) or a physical vignette, and that the details are correct
- Check your passport's remaining validity against your course dates
- Confirm your CAS start date against your actual planned arrival - you generally can't enter the UK more than a set number of days before your course start date (check the current limit on gov.uk)
- Arrange accommodation - many sponsors offer halls of residence with an application deadline well before term starts
- Notify your bank/card providers of your travel dates and destination

The week before

- Save or print: passport photo page, visa/eVisa confirmation, CAS statement, and proof of your accommodation
- Check whether your Immigration Health Surcharge payment needs any separate registration step with the NHS on arrival, per current gov.uk guidance
- Share your itinerary and emergency contacts with someone at home
- Check transit country requirements separately, if your route isn't direct

Day of travel

- Arrive at the airport with sufficient buffer time for an international departure
- Keep your passport, CAS statement, and any printed financial evidence in your hand luggage - not checked baggage
- If you have an eVisa, make sure you can access it in case it's requested

At the UK border

Arriving with a visa doesn't automatically grant entry - a Border Force officer makes the final decision, and can ask questions consistent with your Student visa application. Be ready to briefly confirm your course, institution, and CAS details.

After you arrive

- Register with your sponsor institution by the date they specify - most sponsors have a reporting duty to the Home Office if you don't enrol or check in on time
- Register with a local GP for healthcare access
- Open a UK bank account if needed - most banks will ask for a letter from your sponsor confirming your enrolment
- Check your visa/eVisa conditions for your specific permitted working hours before taking any part-time work